RISK MANAGEMENT STRATEGY

Project: StudentSarthi – Student Income and Part-Time Employment Platform
Methodology: PRINCE2
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1. PURPOSE OF RISK MANAGEMENT

The purpose of risk management in this project is to proactively identify, assess, and control uncertainties that may impact the successful delivery of the StudentSarthi platform.
The approach ensures:

- Early identification of threats and opportunities
- Structured decision-making
- Reduced uncertainty during execution
- Controlled delivery within MVP scope

2. RISK MANAGEMENT APPROACH

The project follows a continuous risk management cycle:
Identify → Assess → Prioritize → Plan Response → Implement → Monitor → Review
Risk management is embedded across all project stages, not treated as a one-time activity.

3. RISK CATEGORIES

3.1 Strategic Risks

Risks affecting overall project success and business value:

- Poor adoption by students
- Lack of employer engagement
- Misalignment with real market needs

3.2 Operational Risks

Risks affecting day-to-day execution:

- Delay in documentation completion
- Poor coordination between simulated roles
- Inefficient task tracking

3.3 Technical Risks

Risks related to system design and feasibility:

- Overcomplex workflow design beyond MVP
- Inconsistent user journey mapping
- Weak data structure definition

3.4 Scope Risks

Risks related to uncontrolled expansion:

- Feature creep beyond MVP
- Addition of advanced features (AI matching, payment systems)
- Uncontrolled requirement changes

3.5 External Risks

Risks outside project control:

- Competition from existing job platforms
- Changing market expectations

- User behavior assumptions not matching reality

4. RISK ASSESSMENT METHOD
Each risk is evaluated using:
4.1 Probability Scale
- Low
- Medium
- High

4.2 Impact Scale
- Low (minor effect)
- Medium (moderate delay or issue)
- High (project failure risk or major delay)

4.3 Risk Priority
Priority is calculated based on:
- High Probability + High Impact = Critical Risk
- Medium + Medium = Moderate Risk
- Low + Low = Minor Risk

5. RISK RESPONSE STRATEGIES
5.1 Avoid
Eliminate risk by changing approach (e.g., remove complex features)
5.2 Mitigate
Reduce probability or impact (e.g., strict MVP scope control)
5.3 Transfer
Shift responsibility (not heavily used in simulation project)
5.4 Accept
Accept risk when impact is low or unavoidable

6. KEY PROJECT RISKS (INITIAL RISK REGISTER)
R1: Scope Creep
- Description: Addition of features beyond MVP (AI, payments, analytics)
- Probability: High
- Impact: High
- Response: Strict MVP control, change approval process

R2: Low Student Adoption
- Description: Students may not actively use platform
- Probability: Medium
- Impact: High
- Response: Strong user-centric design and simple UX

R3: Employer Participation Risk
- Description: Employers may not register or post jobs
- Probability: Medium
- Impact: High
- Response: Simplified onboarding process

R4: Unrealistic Workflow Design
- Description: Overcomplex system design not aligned with reality
- Probability: Medium
- Impact: Medium

- Response: Keep workflows simple and validated

R5: Requirement Misinterpretation

- Description: Incorrect understanding of user needs
- Probability: Medium
- Impact: Medium
- Response: Clear user journey mapping before design

R6: Documentation Inconsistency

- Description: Misalignment between PID sections
- Probability: Low
- Impact: Medium
- Response: Regular cross-checking and validation

R7: Time Delay in Phases

- Description: Delay in completing stages
- Probability: Medium
- Impact: Medium
- Response: Strict milestone tracking

R8: Poor Data Structure Design

- Description: Weak system structure affecting scalability
- Probability: Low
- Impact: High
- Response: Early structured design planning

7. RISK MONITORING PROCESS

7.1 Continuous Monitoring

Risks are reviewed:

- Weekly during project updates
- At each stage boundary
- During issue escalation

7.2 Risk Register Updates

Each risk entry includes:

- Description
- Category
- Probability
- Impact
- Priority
- Mitigation action
- Owner
- Status

7.3 Escalation Rules

- High risks → Project Board immediately
- Medium risks → Project Manager review
- Low risks → Logged and monitored

8. RISK OWNERSHIP

Role	Responsibility
Project Manager	Overall risk control and register maintenance
Executive	Business-level risk acceptance
Senior User	User-related risk validation
Senior Supplier	Technical risk evaluation

9. RISK MANAGEMENT PRINCIPLES

- Risks are managed proactively, not reactively
- Early identification is prioritized
- All risks must be documented and traceable
- No undocumented risks are allowed
- Risk review is continuous throughout all project stages

10. SUMMARY

The Risk Management Strategy for StudentSarthi ensures structured identification and control of uncertainties across all phases of delivery. By focusing on MVP discipline, clear governance, and continuous monitoring, the project reduces execution uncertainty and improves delivery success probability.